Depending on your OS, you'll use either Bash (Linux and macOS) or PowerShell (Windows) to script.

One important feature of the CLI needs explanation before you can begin. The `--query` option uses JMESPath syntax, which is a query language for JSON, to extract data from the result. Doing this can be useful because usually you need only a specific field from the result. The following CLI command gets a list of all AMIs in JSON format:

```
$ aws ec2 describe-images --filters \
➥  "Name=name,Values=amzn2-ami-hvm-2.0.202*-x86_64-gp2"     ①
{
  "Images": [
    {
      "ImageId": "ami-0ce1e3f77cd41957e",
      "State": "available"
      [...]
    },
    [...]
    {
      "ImageId": "ami-08754599965c30981",
      "State": "available"
    }
  ]
}
```

① The filter returns only Amazon Linux 2 images for AMD/Intel.

The output is overwhelming. To start an EC2 instance, you need the `ImageId` without all the other information. With JMESPath, you can extract just that information, like so:

```
$ aws ec2 describe-images --filters \
➥ "Name=name,Values=amzn2-ami-hvm-2.0.202*-x86_64-gp2" \
➥ --query "Images[0].ImageId"        ①
"ami-146e2a7c"
```

① Returns the first image ID from the list

The output is wrapped in quotes. This is caused by the default setting of the AWS CLI to output all data in JSON format and JSON strings are enclosed in quotes. To change that, use the `--output text` option as